In the aftermath of the attacks, Ratan was so distraught by the havoc the terrorists had wreaked in the lives of hundreds of innocent people that he took upon himself the responsibility of extending relief and rehabilitation measures even to those not part of the Tata Group. To him, all the victims and their families had to be assisted. This thought arose from the recognition that the attack was aimed at the nation and the terrorists had wanted to destroy the spirit of Mumbai. The generous benefits he extended to all who were affected were virtually unparalleled in the history of the country, or perhaps anywhere in the world. The beneficiaries included police personnel, commandos, street vendors, pedestrians and railway employees.

Ratan reckoned that the measures had to be both short and long term in nature. He found it necessary to take this approach as he discovered that the government system was woefully inadequate to address the victims' requirements in such situations. The crisis had exposed the drawbacks.

With this larger objective of establishing a system that would try and fill the lacunae, in December 2008, within weeks of the attack, Ratan, along with Krishna Kumar, set up the TPSWT. One major task was to identify and locate all the victims. Batliwala mentions that after a hectic search, 168 people were identified. Some came knocking at the TPSWT's door themselves, and no one went back disappointed, recalls Batliwala. Even hawkers who had lost their wares in the attack were given brand new handcarts.

The trust took upon itself the responsibility of the education of forty-six children of victims of the terror attack. It also met the victims' medical expenses and extended life-changing opportunities to them. One such family was that of Shaunak Chemburkar, a bell captain in the neighbouring Oberoi-Trident. He had lost his life during the attack and left behind a ten-year-old daughter, a sixty-five-year-old mother suffering from Alzheimer's and a paralysed father besides his wife, Anjali. On hearing the news of his death, his mother went into a coma and his father collapsed. Chemburkar's daughter stopped going to school as the family could not afford the fees.

The TPSWT reached out to Anjali. A counsellor was arranged for her, and the trust began paying her daughter's fees. Anjali says that the trust gave her the courage to handle her future. They got her to learn a skill. She was keen on doing a beautician's course, which she proudly says she did and topped her class. Her daughter eventually completed her graduation.